10 Quant Firms That Hire Out of Undergrad

What each firm does, how to get in, when recruiting actually opens, and where to apply. Timelines reflect typical cycles; always confirm dates on each firm's careers page.

1. Jane Street

The gold standard of quant trading, and it hires undergrads every year.

WHAT IT IS

A global proprietary trading firm and market maker across ETFs, equities, bonds, options, and commodities. It is known for collaborative teams, heavy use of OCaml, and interviews built around probability, estimation, and betting games rather than finance knowledge.

HOW TO GET IN

1. Apply for the Quantitative Trader, Quantitative Researcher, or Software Engineer internship.
2. Look for short exploration programs for first- and second-year students to get in the door early.
3. Drill expected value, conditional probability, and quick estimation out loud.
4. Practice market-making games: quoting a spread, updating on new information, sizing bets.
5. Talk through your reasoning in interviews, since the process is graded as much as the answer.

WHEN RECRUITING OPENS

Internship applications for the following summer typically open in early-to-mid summer and are reviewed on a rolling basis. Underclassman programs usually open earlier in the year.

WHERE TO APPLY

https://www.janestreet.com/join-jane-street/

2. Citadel Securities

One of the largest market makers in the world.

WHAT IT IS

A market maker that handles a huge share of U.S. retail equity volume and trades across equities, options, rates, and FX. It is a separate company from Citadel, the hedge fund, and recruits for its own trading, research, and engineering roles.

HOW TO GET IN

1. Apply to the Quantitative Trading, Quantitative Research, or Software Engineering internship.
2. Check for discovery-style programs and datathons aimed at underclassmen.
3. Expect online assessments covering math, probability, and coding before any interviews.
4. Review statistics fundamentals like distributions, regression, and variance.
5. Prepare a clear story about why market making, not just why finance.

WHEN RECRUITING OPENS

Typically opens in mid-to-late summer for the next year's internship, with interviews running through the fall.

WHERE TO APPLY

https://www.citadelsecurities.com/careers/

3. Hudson River Trading

Algorithmic trading run like a top tech company.

WHAT IT IS

A fully algorithmic trading firm where strategies are researched, coded, and deployed by small teams. Roles lean heavily on programming, so it is a strong fit for CS and math majors who want trading upside with an engineering culture.

HOW TO GET IN

1. Apply for the Algorithm Developer (quant research) or Software Engineer internship.
2. Sharpen C++ or Python, since coding rounds carry real weight here.
3. Practice LeetCode-style problems alongside probability puzzles.
4. Build a small project, like a backtester or order book simulator, and put it on GitHub.
5. Be ready to discuss trade-offs in speed, memory, and correctness.

WHEN RECRUITING OPENS

Usually opens in summer for the following year's internships and fills on a rolling basis, so early applications have an edge.

WHERE TO APPLY

https://www.hudsonrivertrading.com/careers/

4. Optiver

A leading options market maker with a famous math test.

WHAT IT IS

A global market maker founded in Amsterdam, known for options trading and a fast-paced, numbers-first trading floor. Its process is known for timed mental math and numerical reasoning assessments early on.

HOW TO GET IN

1. Apply to the Trader or Quantitative Researcher internship, or the Software Engineer track.
2. Practice timed mental math daily until speed and accuracy hold up under pressure.
3. Learn options basics: calls, puts, put-call parity, and how volatility affects price.
4. Play sequence, pattern, and probability games to warm up for the online tests.
5. Stay calm in trading simulations; consistent decisions beat big swings.

WHEN RECRUITING OPENS

Generally opens in summer for the next year's internship class. Assessments arrive quickly after you apply, so prep before you hit submit.

WHERE TO APPLY

https://optiver.com/working-at-optiver/career-opportunities/

5. IMC Trading

Technology-driven market making across global markets.

WHAT IT IS

A trading firm founded in Amsterdam that provides liquidity across equities, options, ETFs, and futures. It blends trading and technology closely, with traders, researchers, and engineers working side by side.

HOW TO GET IN

1. Apply for the Quant Trader, Quant Researcher, or Software Engineer internship.
2. Prepare for numerical and logical reasoning tests in the first round.
3. Practice probability problems like dice, cards, and coin-flip expected value.
4. Brush up on basic options and market-making concepts.
5. Show curiosity about markets with examples of games, competitions, or projects.

WHEN RECRUITING OPENS

Typically opens in summer for the following year's internships, with rolling review through the fall.

WHERE TO APPLY

https://www.imc.com/

6. Susquehanna (SIG)

Decision science, options, and poker as training.

WHAT IT IS

A global trading firm with deep roots in options, known for teaching decision-making through game theory and poker. It hires a large number of undergrads and recruits from a wide range of schools, making it one of the more accessible top firms.

HOW TO GET IN

1. Apply to the Assistant Trader, Quantitative Research, or Software Developer internship.
2. Look for short discovery or insight days for underclassmen.
3. Learn basic poker strategy and expected value thinking.
4. Practice probability brainteasers and quick mental math.
5. Explain how you make decisions under uncertainty, with real examples.

WHEN RECRUITING OPENS

Internship recruiting usually opens in summer and continues on a rolling basis into the fall, with underclassman events earlier in the year.

WHERE TO APPLY

https://careers.sig.com/

7. Jump Trading

Research-first trading with small, elite intern classes.

WHAT IT IS

A research-driven trading firm working across asset classes, with major investments in technology and infrastructure. Intern classes are small, so the bar is high and the work is real from day one.

HOW TO GET IN

1. Apply to the Quantitative Researcher, Quantitative Trader, or Software Engineer internship.
2. Highlight research experience, competitions, or strong math and CS coursework.
3. Prepare for statistics and probability depth, not just puzzles.
4. Review linear algebra, regression, and basic machine learning ideas.
5. Be ready to walk through a project in technical detail.

WHEN RECRUITING OPENS

Typically opens in summer for the following year, with limited spots that fill early.

WHERE TO APPLY

https://www.jumptrading.com/careers/

8. Five Rings

A small, selective prop shop with outsized pay.

WHAT IT IS

A proprietary trading firm in New York with a small team and a reputation for very high compensation and very selective hiring. Interviews focus on math, probability, and logical problem-solving.

HOW TO GET IN

1. Apply to the Quantitative Trader or Software Developer internship.
2. Grind challenging probability and combinatorics problems.
3. Practice explaining solutions clearly and checking your own work.
4. Use math competition experience if you have it; it is directly relevant.
5. Apply early, because class sizes are small.

WHEN RECRUITING OPENS

Usually opens in summer for the next year's internships, with rolling review.

WHERE TO APPLY

https://fiverings.com/

9. DRW

Diversified trading across markets, with a big Chicago presence.

WHAT IT IS

A diversified trading firm founded in Chicago that trades across asset classes, from rates and commodities to options and crypto. It hires undergrads into trading, quant research, and engineering roles.

HOW TO GET IN

1. Apply to the Quantitative Trader, Quantitative Researcher, or Software Engineer internship.
2. Prepare for online math and coding assessments in the first round.
3. Learn the basics of futures, options, and how different markets connect.
4. Practice probability and estimation problems out loud.
5. Show genuine interest in markets with a view you can defend.

WHEN RECRUITING OPENS

Typically opens in summer for the following year's internships and runs through the fall.

WHERE TO APPLY

https://drw.com/

10. Two Sigma

A systematic investment manager built on data and science.

WHAT IT IS

A technology-driven investment manager that uses data science, machine learning, and distributed computing to build systematic strategies. It is more research and engineering focused than a traditional market maker.

HOW TO GET IN

1. Apply to the Quantitative Researcher or Software Engineer internship.
2. Build data science projects with real datasets and publish them on GitHub.
3. Review statistics, machine learning fundamentals, and Python.
4. Practice coding interviews alongside probability questions.
5. Explain how you would test whether a pattern in data is real or noise.

WHEN RECRUITING OPENS

Usually opens in late summer for the following year's internships, with interviews through the fall.

WHERE TO APPLY

https://www.twosigma.com/careers/

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